

migrated back to the district of birth at the time of the census. Accordingly, if a person's district of birth and district of usual residence are the same at the time of the census, he or she is defined as a life-time non-migrant.

Net Migration Rate

The 'Net Migration Rate' is defined as the number of net migrants per thousand of the usually resident population in a district. A positive net migration rate indicates that in-migration to the district is relatively higher, whereas a negative value indicates that out-migration from the district is relatively higher.

Lifetime Migration Effectiveness Ratio (LMER)

The LMER is a demographic indicator that measures the "efficiency" or net impact of migration flows into and out of an area over the lifetime of its current residence. It is calculated using the following formula:

$$LMER = \frac{(\text{Lifetime In migration} - \text{Lifetime Out migration})}{(\text{Lifetime In migration} + \text{Lifetime Out migration})} \times 100$$

Lifetime migration

Table 5.1.1 provides an overview of the lifetime migration patterns in Sri Lanka as of the Census of Population and Housing - 2024.

Table 5.1.1 : Lifetime Migrants by District of Dirth and District of Usual Residence, 2024

District	Usual resident population (no roofless and foreign born) (a)	Population born by district of birth (b)	population currently residing in their birth district (c)	Foreign born population	Number of lifetime migrants (d)	% of Lifetime migrant to usual resident population (d)/(a)*100
Sri Lanka	21,755,774	21,755,774	18,922,950	23,709	2,832,824	13.0
Colombo	2,367,524	2,176,000	1,876,288	7,345	491,236	20.7
Gampaha	2,432,195	2,074,667	1,941,334	3,718	490,861	20.2
Kalutara	1,304,757	1,242,525	1,123,880	951	180,877	13.9
Kandy	1,460,164	1,585,038	1,302,243	1,591	157,921	10.8
Matale	526,495	548,896	448,233	354	78,262	14.9
Nuwara Eliya	725,003	836,051	672,433	248	52,570	7.3
Galle	1,096,263	1,188,742	1,008,225	962	88,038	8.0
Matara	837,418	956,258	754,961	338	82,457	9.8
Hambantota	671,189	709,865	606,207	194	64,982	9.7
Jaffna	593,590	646,935	567,486	1,109	26,104	4.4
Mannar	123,213	129,573	107,846	539	15,367	12.5
Vavuniya	171,256	139,892	121,244	1,024	50,012	29.2
Mullaitivu	122,464	109,333	93,185	153	29,279	23.9
Kilinochchi	136,397	120,243	103,674	313	32,723	24.0
Batticaloa	595,672	602,329	576,636	217	19,036	3.2
Ampara	744,304	725,616	672,037	227	72,267	9.7
Trincomalee	442,143	447,395	408,509	579	33,634	7.6
Kurunegala	1,766,965	1,776,441	1,574,556	1,058	192,409	10.9
Puttalam	817,466	793,740	717,800	1,237	99,666	12.2
Anuradhapura	959,507	925,982	814,641	394	144,866	15.1
Polonnaruwa	447,304	410,823	353,730	199	93,574	20.9
Badulla	871,974	960,329	801,537	265	70,437	8.1
Moneragala	527,459	507,458	446,067	73	81,392	15.4
Ratnapura	1,145,019	1,207,749	1,055,938	233	89,081	7.8
Kegalle	870,033	933,894	774,260	388	95,773	11.0